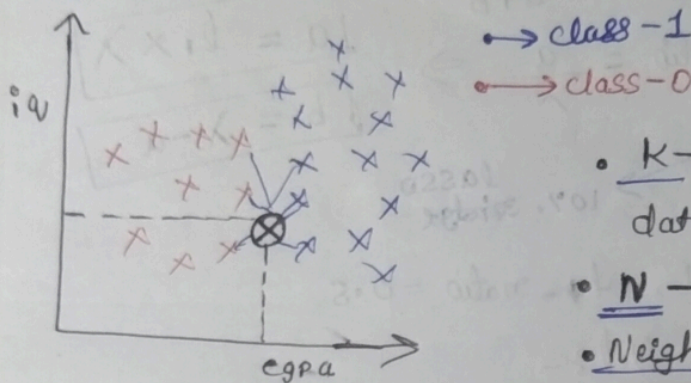


K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN)

Classifier

KNN (K-Nearest Neighbors) is a Supervised Machine Learning algorithm used for classification & Regression.

→ In classification, KNN predicts the class label of a new data point based on the most common class among its nearest neighbors.



- K → number of nearest data points considered
- N → based on nearest distance
- Neighbors → nearby data points in the feature space.

→ Non-Parametric :-

- KNN does not learn parameters like weights or coefficients. It stores the entire training dataset.

→ Lazy Learner :-

- No training happens during fit()
- All computation happens during prediction.

How KNN works :-

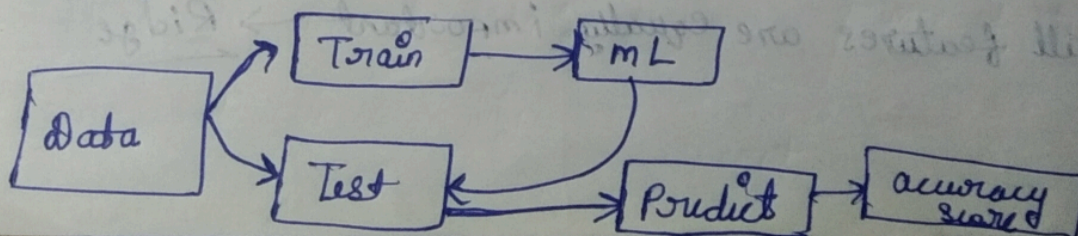
- Choose a value of k (number of Neighbors)
- For a new data point

→ Calculate the distance b/w this point and all training points

→ Select the k -Nearest points

→ performing majority voting among these k -points

→ Assign the class with the highest votes.



Importance Of feature Scaling :-

KNN is distance-based, so scale matters.

Example :- feature 1 : Age (0-100)

feature 2 : Salary (0-100000)

→ without scaling : Salary dominates distance

→ with scaling : All features contribute equally

Choosing Value of K :-

Large K

i) Small ($K=1$)

- over sensitive to noise
- overfitting
- High Variance

ii) Smooth decision boundary

- underfitting
- High bias

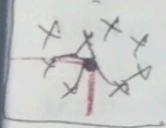
data

heuristic

$\sqrt{n} \Rightarrow n$ - no. of observation

400 $\Rightarrow \sqrt{400} = 20$

Ex:-



take odd value for K

19 21

if $K=4$.

→ class 1 = 2
→ class 2 = 2

Experimentation

Cross validation

$n=1000$

800

(Training)

200

(Testing)

diff

KNN

KNN-1 83

KNN-2 81

KNN-25 89

Trained again on Training data

Decision Surface [Decision Boundary] :-

A decision surface is the region in the feature space where a machine learning model decides which class a data point belongs to.

→ It separates different classes.

• for 2 features → it becomes decision boundary (line / curve)

• for more than 2 features → it becomes a surface or hyper plane

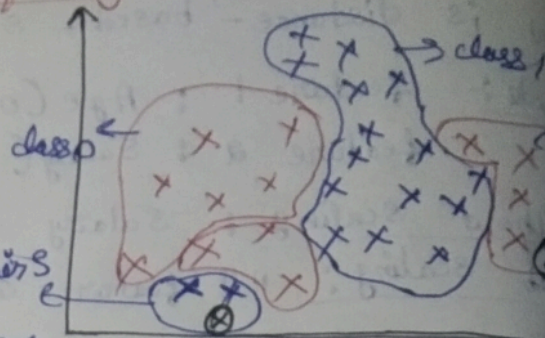


we extend
to plot surfaces

• A decision surface is the boundary that separates different class regions learned by a classifier

Overfitting and Underfitting in KNN

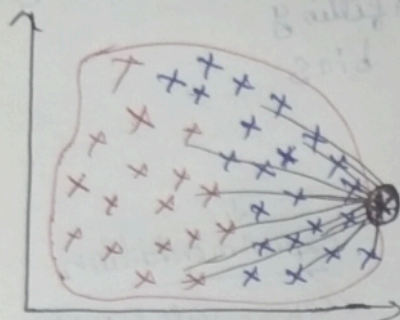
Capa / iv / Placed
| | |
200 datapoints



i) when $k=1$ | high variance

→ if new data point is nearest to the red region (even if it is an outlier), then it belongs to class 0.

→ when $k = \text{maximum}$, $k=200$



consider blue points are more in number
blue > red

majority count ⇒ class blue

many far-away points influence prediction
local patterns are ignored (minority class are ignored)

is lost
patterns lost
cannot capture local patterns

Limitations of KNN:-

i) Slow Prediction Time:- for every new data point, KNN

- Computes distance to all training points
- Sorts them ascending
- Complexity ⇒ $O(N \times D)$

→ N = Number of training Samples

→ D = number of features

• Not suitable for large datasets or real-time system

ii) High Memory Usage:-

- KNN stores the entire training dataset
- No model Compression

→ memory inefficient for big data

iii) High dimensional data:- $f=500$ / curse of dimensionality

• curse of dimensionality ⇒ distance concept ⇒ not suitable

iv) Large datasets:- $n = 5 \text{ Lakh}$, $f = 100$ (5,00,000, 100)

• Knn is a lazy learning technique.

• ^{during} training $\rightarrow$ nothing

v) Sensitive to feature Scaling:-

• Distance based algorithm

• Features with large scale dominate

$\rightarrow$ without scaling $\Rightarrow$ wrong neighbors

$\rightarrow$ Requires mandatory scaling

Eg:-

• age (0-100)

• Salary (0-10,00,000)

vi) Sensitive to noise and outliers:-

$\rightarrow$ Nearby noisy points influence prediction

$\rightarrow$ Especially when k is small.

$\rightarrow$ A single noisy point can change classification.

vii) Poor Performance on imbalanced dataset:-

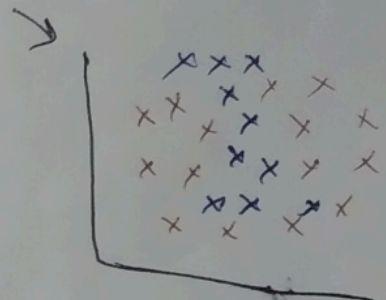
• majority class dominates voting, minority class gets ignored • Bias predictions

viii) No learning or Interpretability:-

• No parameters (weights, coefficients)

• No clear feature importance

• Hard to explain predictions



$\rightarrow$ Yes $\Rightarrow$ 91%

$\rightarrow$ No $\Rightarrow$ 9%

ix) Affected by irrelevant features:-

x) No robust to missing values:

xi) Difficult to choose optimal k

xii)